

After a Scam: What to Do Next

Move quickly, one step at a time

1

Call the payment company

Ask the bank, card issuer, or payment service whether the payment can be stopped or reversed.

2

Secure your accounts

Change affected passwords and turn on two-step verification.

3

Save evidence

Keep messages, receipts, phone numbers, account details, and dates.

4

Report the scam

Visit [ReportFraud.ftc.gov](https://reportfraud.ftc.gov). For internet crime, visit [IC3.gov](https://ic3.gov).

5

Watch for recovery scams

Do not pay anyone who guarantees they can recover lost money.

Being scammed is not your fault. Asking for help is the right next step.